

ChromoTone Help

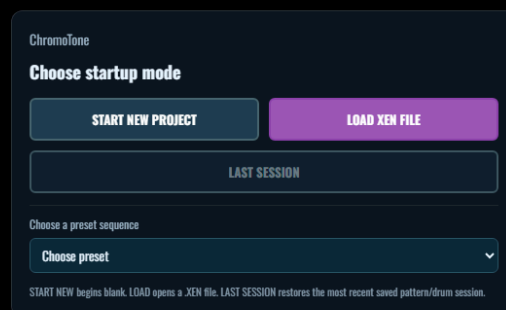
A quick-start guide and screen-by-screen manual

- **NOTE ChromoTone syncs MIDI and Audio by playing a ping / frequency sweep - make sure to output that ping to your monitors rather than the audience or they will hear it. Adjustable in settings.**

ChromoTone is a microtonal harmony, sequencing, tuning, loop, and live instrument. This guide is written for musicians who want to get ideas out fast-fast. Then a dependable reference for what each button, slider etc does.

Your First 10 Minutes

Opening screen

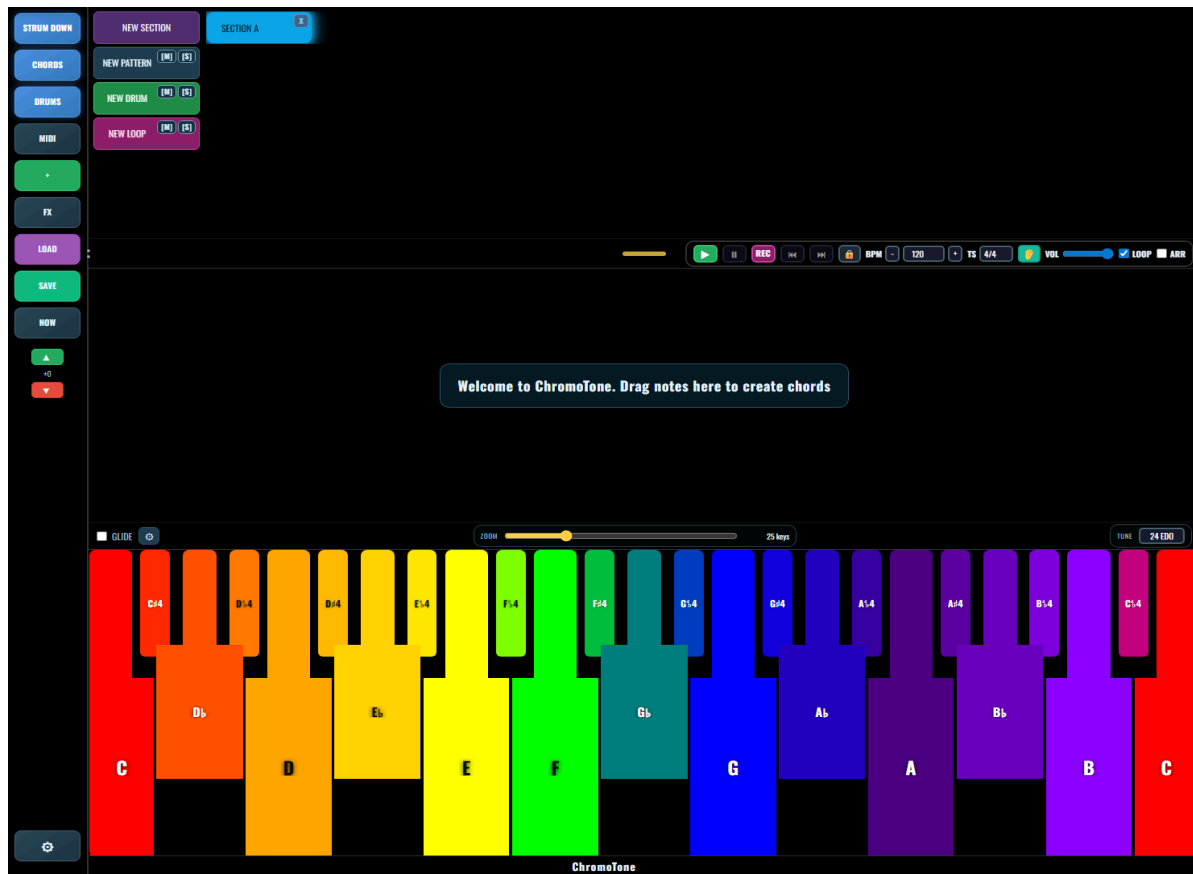


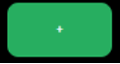
- **START NEW PROJECT** gives you a clean session.
- **LOAD XEN FILE** restores a saved ChromoTone project.
- **LAST SESSION** reopens the last locally saved working session (saved in browser)

- **CHOOSE PRESET** - There are a bunch of presets at the bottom to get started fast
 * To add a chord sequence to the preset list CLICK and HOLD the SAVE button on the main screen

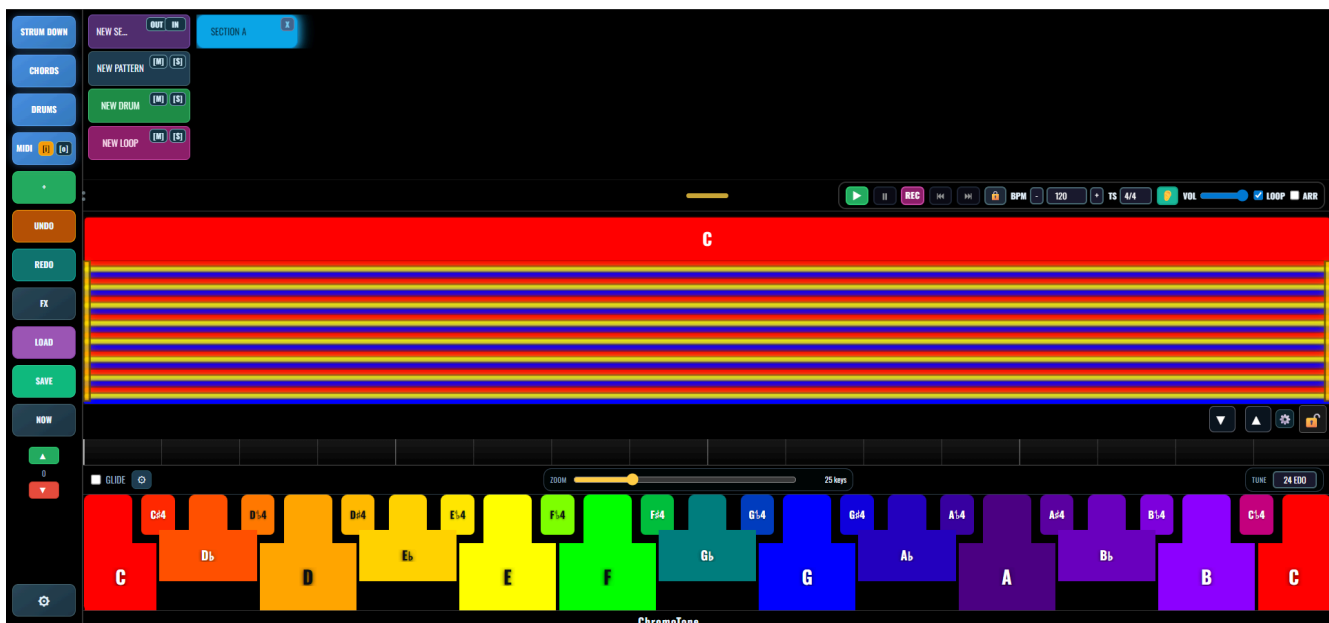
FROM SCRATCH!

Open ChromoTone and choose **START NEW PROJECT**. You should see a screen that looks like this.



Press  on the left sidebar OR your  key on your keyboard to create the first chord box.

Type “C”
 press ENTER



You have made a **C major** chord, **YEAH!**

*If you have a touchscreen you can **STRUM** the strings with your finger or use your mouse cursor / mousewheel to scroll-strum.*

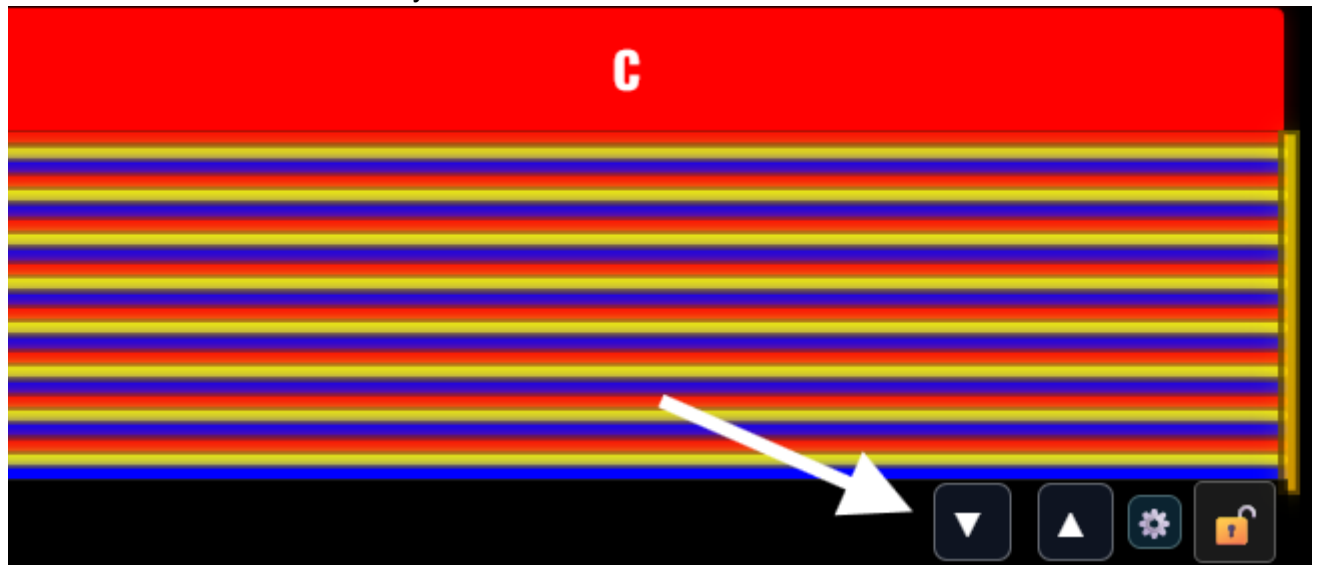
You can type pretty much any chord you can imagine eg **Cmaj7** or **Cm6/9addb6**

To type a **microtonal** chord use up and down ^ and v characters

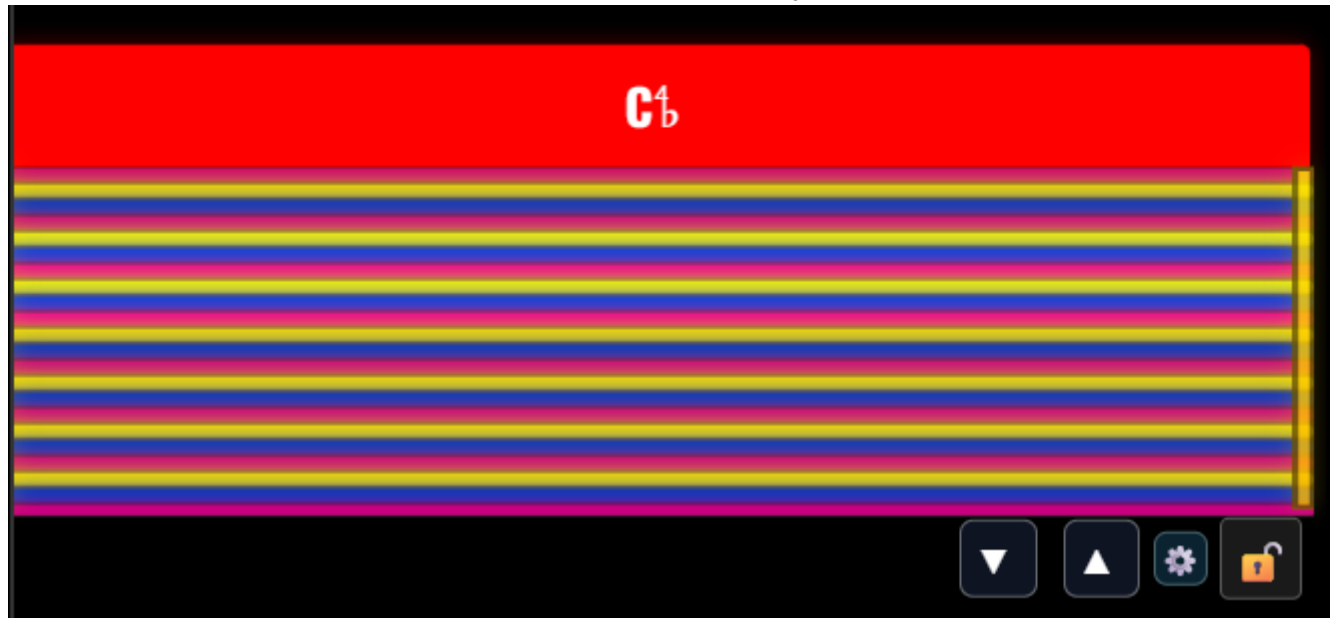
To create **C[#]7** (C half-sharp 7) type C^7

To create **C_b7** (C half-flat 7) type Cv7 into the chordbox

Click the **CHORD NAME** directly to edit it



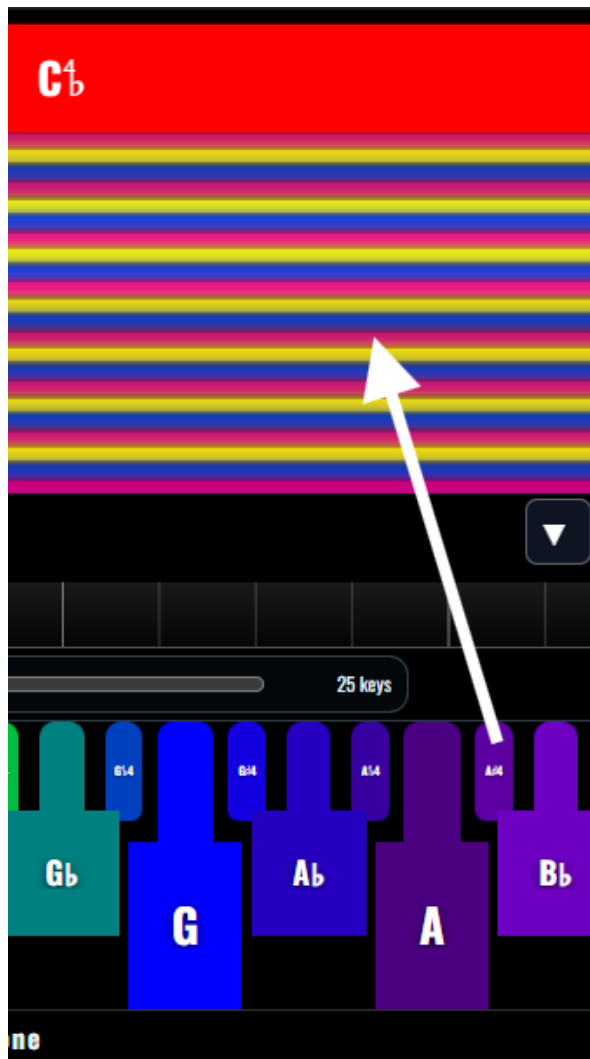
Press the down / up buttons to **TRANSPOSE** the chordbox by 1 microtonal step



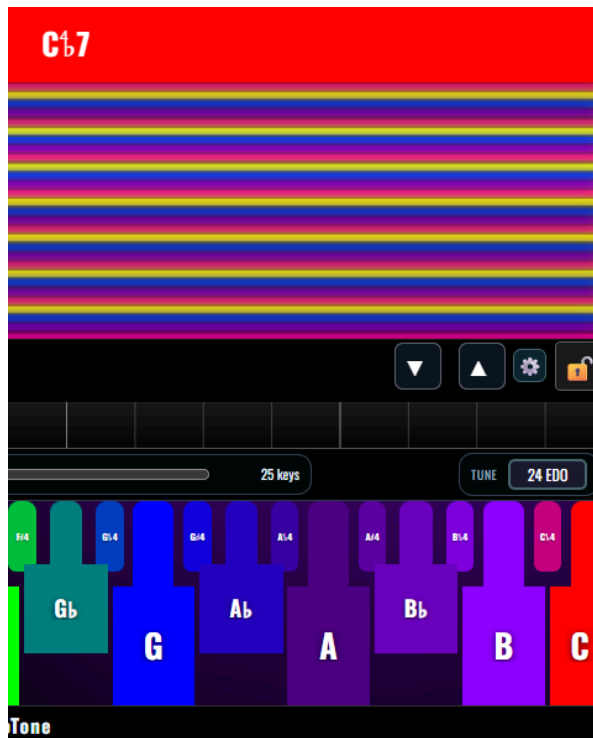
(The Gear icon will open settings for that chordbox - covered later)

The lock icon will lock the chordbox so it can't be changed accidentally.

Another way to add notes to the chord is by dragging the notes directly from the keyboard below.



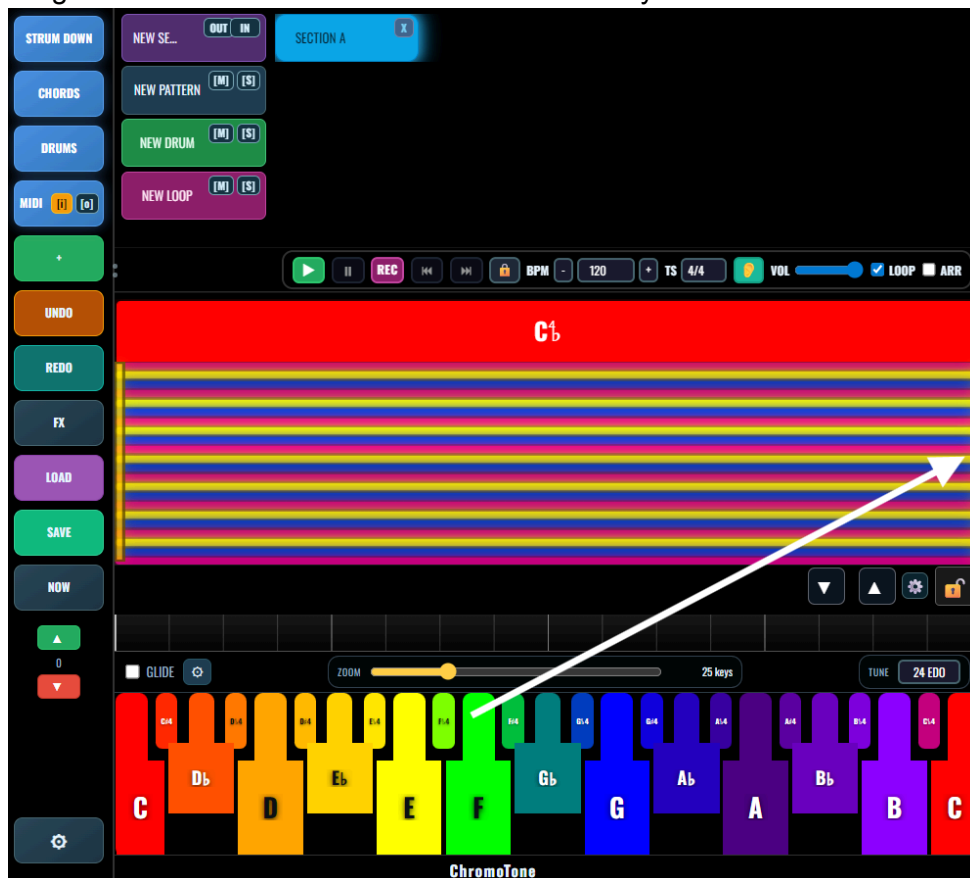
Becomes



If you drag the note in **AGAIN**, it will **REMOVE** it from the chord leaving you **C_b**

To add **ANOTHER** chord you can repeat the whole process OR....

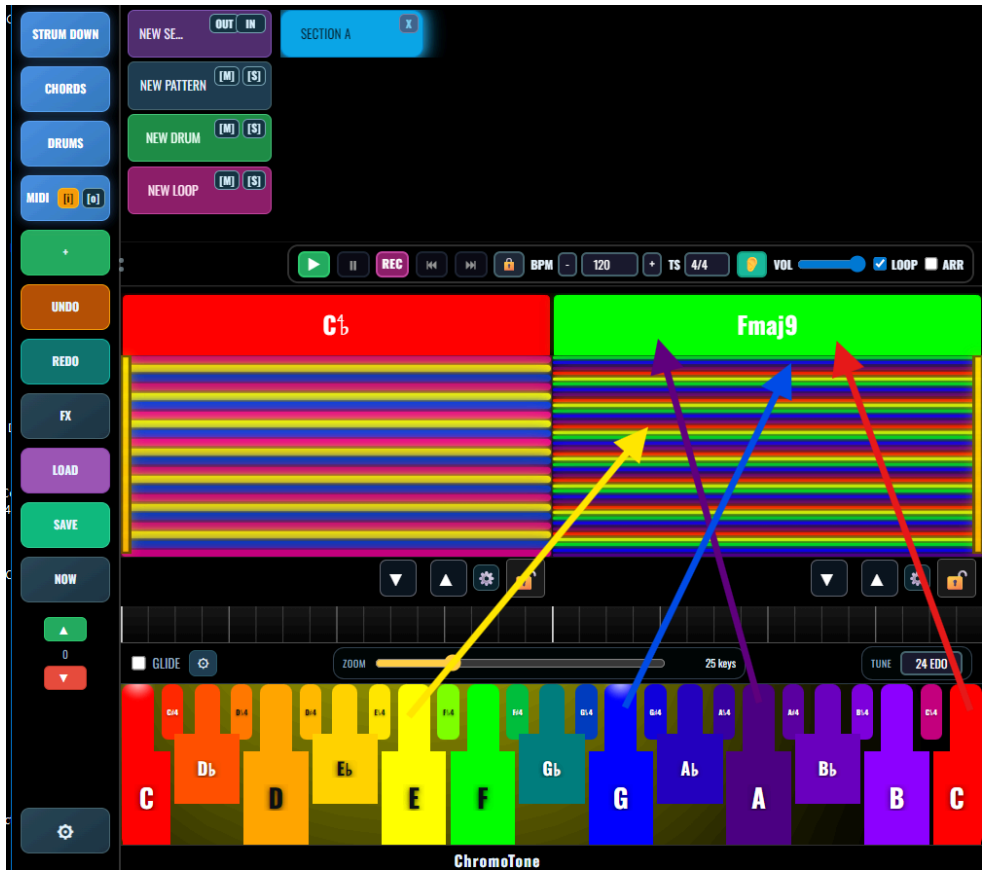
Drag a **NOTE** from the bottom **KEYBOARD** to any **YELLOW HANDLE** to the right or left of your existing chord



That creates a bunch of F notes in all octaves.



Now drag any other notes into the F box to finish the chord



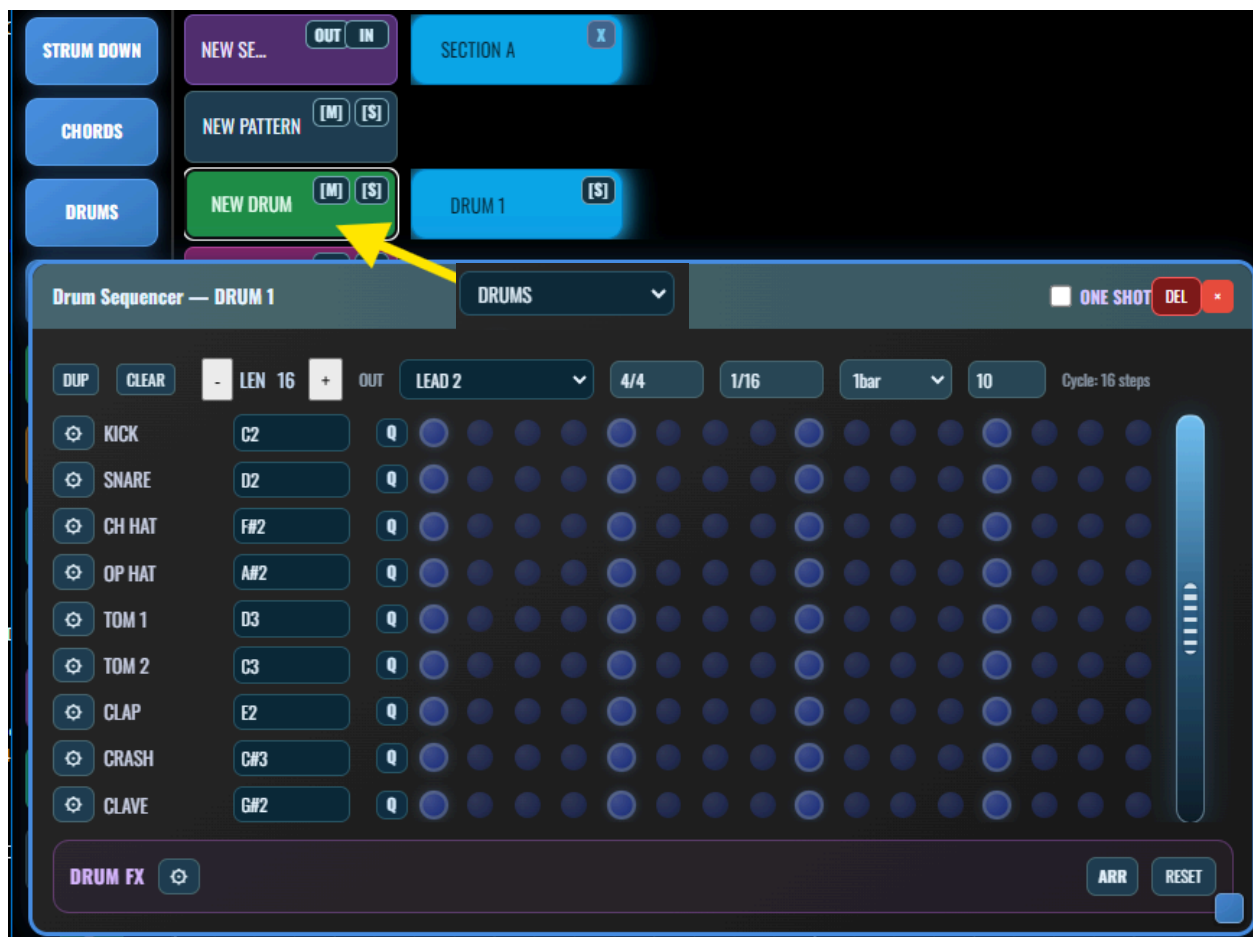
So now we have **C** and **Fmaj9**

Press PLAY if you haven't already.

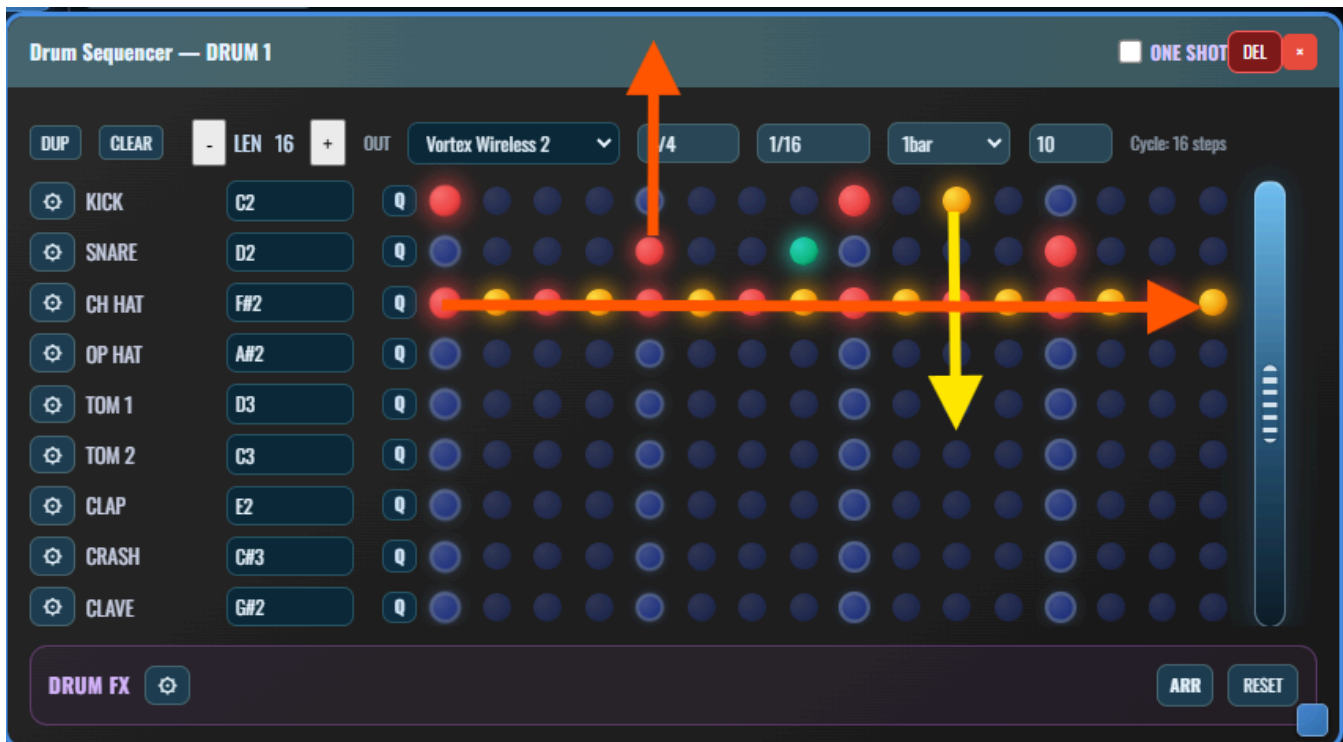


*Note If LOOP box is checked, the chords will loop at the tempo / time signature given on the transport row.
Currently 120 beats per minute BPM and 4/4 time.

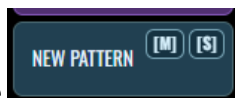
Click **NEW DRUM** - this will bring up a new drum pattern. Time goes left to right.
A bar of 4/4 is split into sixteen 16th notes.



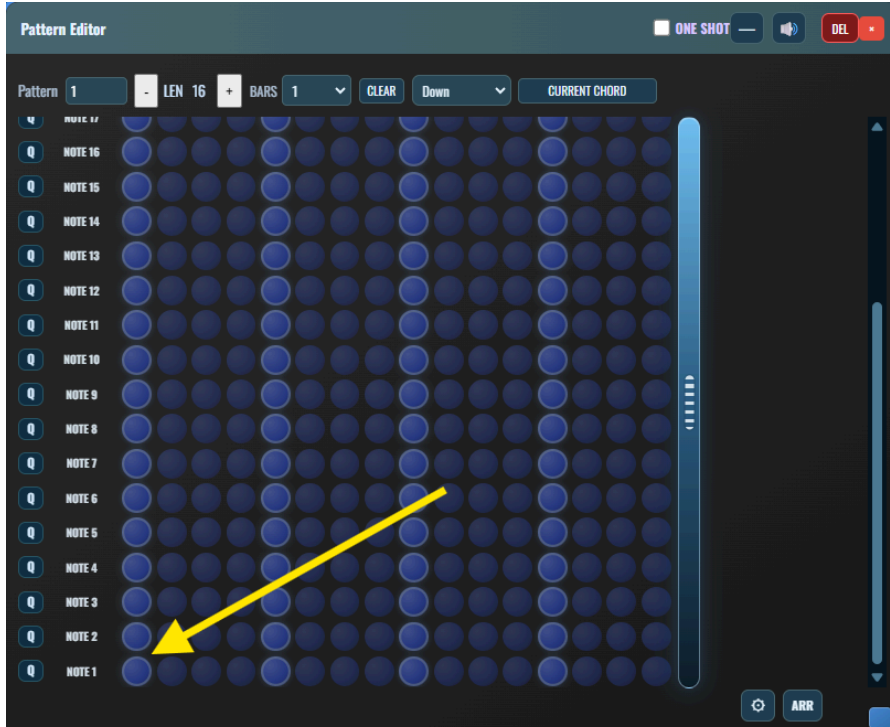
- Click a dot to activate a drum hit on that beat
- Click-drag the note downwards to make the drum/ note quieter
- Click-drag the dot upwards to make the drum / note louder
- Click-drag a dot to the right to paint dots in or erase existing one



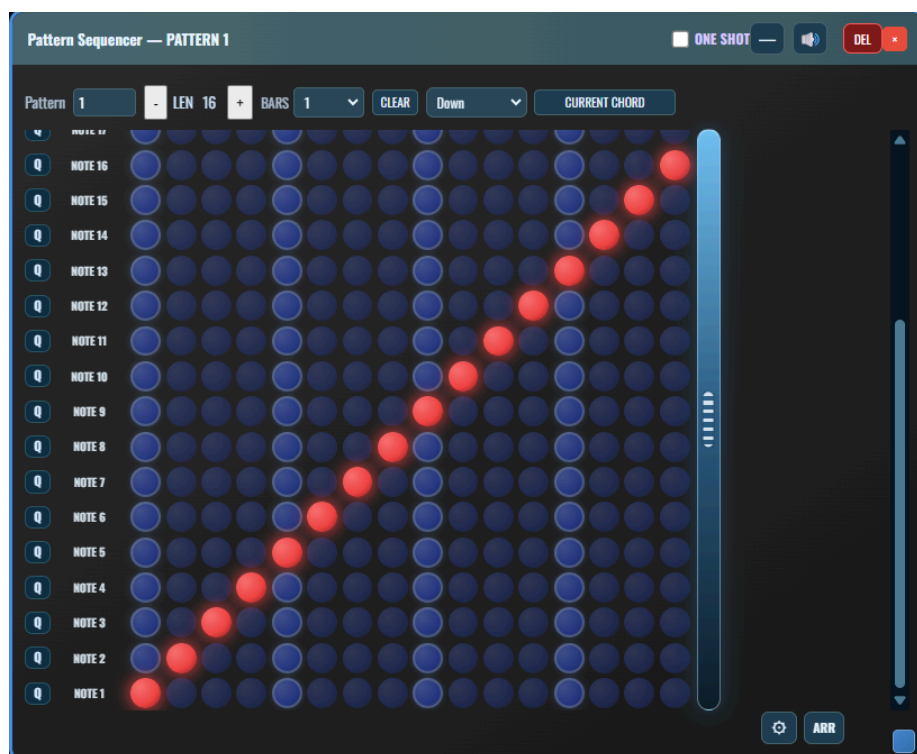
If you have pressed play you should be hearing a drum beat and the two chords looping around.



Click the button this will bring up a similar window.

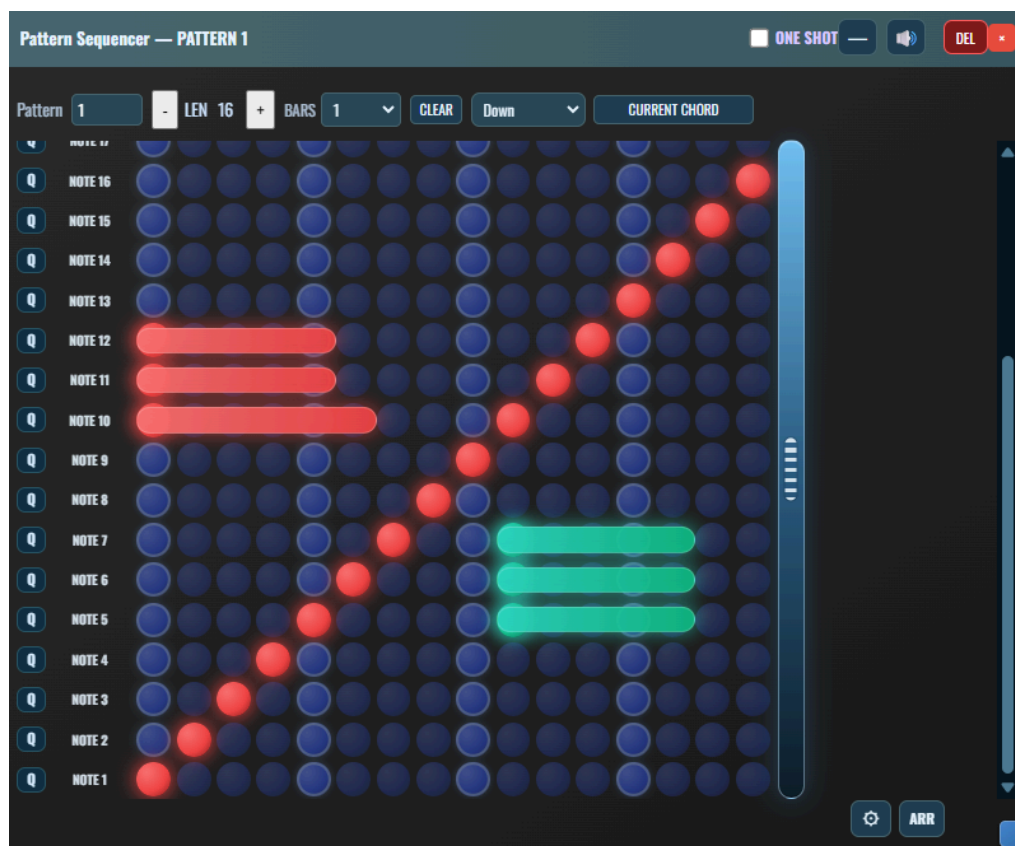


NOTE 1 is the **ROOT** note so if your chord is **C major** then:
NOTE 1 will be **C**, **NOTE 2** will be **E** and **NOTE 3** will be **G**.
NOTE 4 will be **C** again one octave higher and so on up



If your chord is more complex ie **Fmaj9** then **NOTE 1,2,3,4,5,6** are **F,G,A,C,E,F** respectively
(NOTE 2 becomes the 9th as it is the also the 2nd)

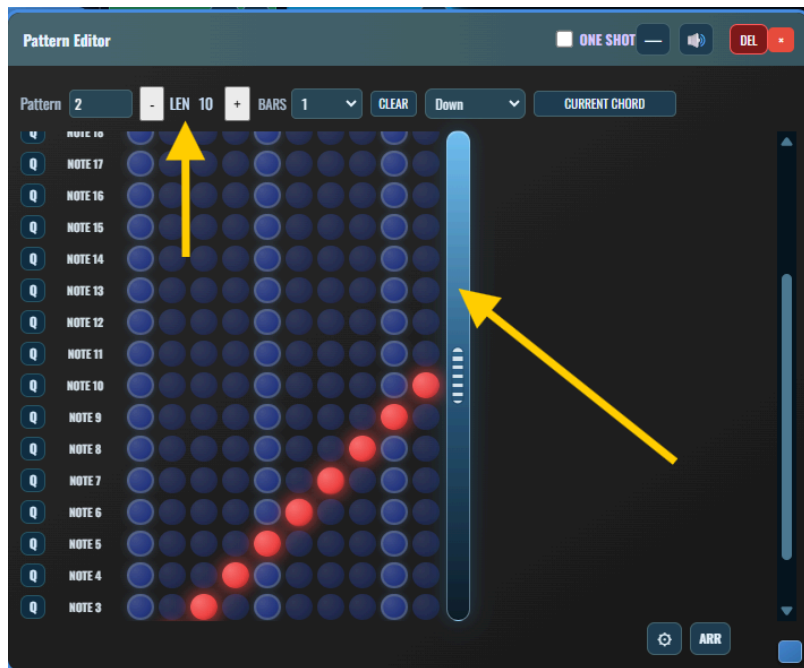
Each time the current chord changes, the pattern plays the order of the dots you entered.



- Create chords by click-draggin a note

- Change velocity by dragging a note up or down.

LEN is the length of the pattern regardless of the time signature. You can change **LEN** with the **+ / -** keys or by dragging the handle to the right of the dots to shorten or lengthen the duration of the pattern this is used for polyrhythmic patterns and phasing patterns (when two similar patterns go out of sync because of a missing beat)



CURRENT CHORD button toggles whether the **PATTERN** follows the chords or is independent (with absolute note names)

- **CURRENT CHORD** - Forces the current chord to the pattern.
- **ALL CHORDS** - Restricts the palette of notes to the ones in the chordboxes. - Independent notes
- **ALL NOTES** - No restrictions - Independent notes

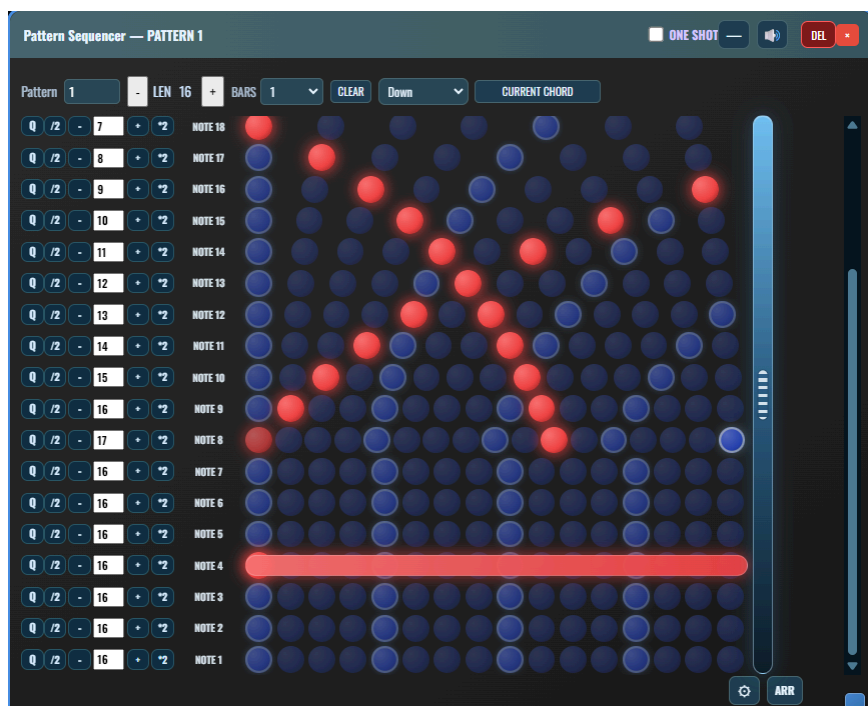
ALL CHORDS



ALL NOTES



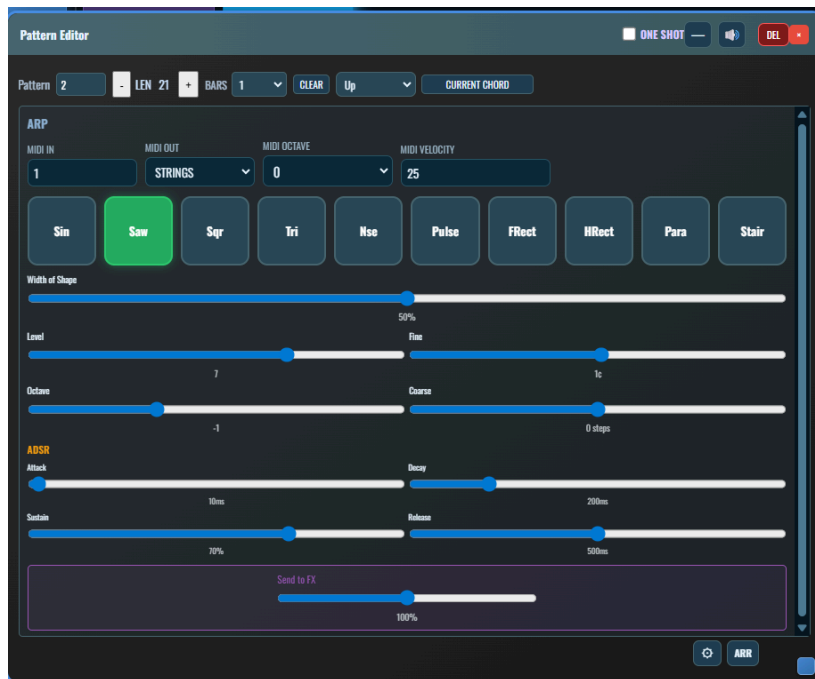
Q is **PER NOTE QUANTIZE** and will determine how many dots/notes there are in each bar **PER NOTE**. Use for creating supremely wonky rhythms



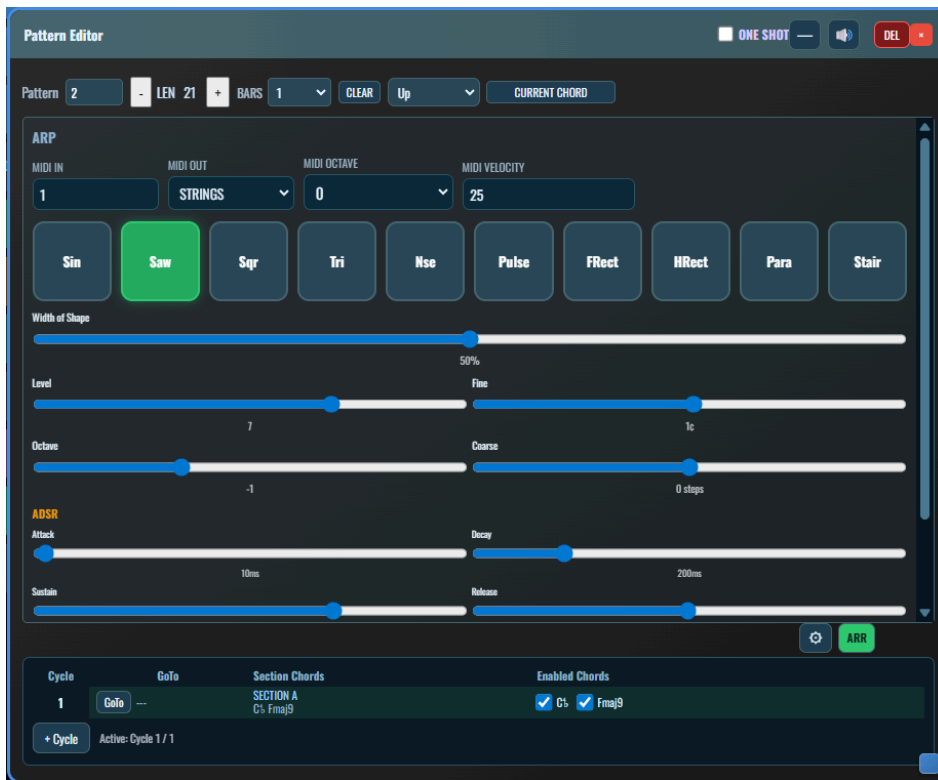
If you click the  Gear icon inside the pattern editor you go under the hood and can change the sounds that the pattern plays.

Click SAW and the oscillator becomes a sawwave generator.

- **Oscillator shape** and width (Sin waves can be stretched to be wide like a square or narrow like an impulse)
- **Level** - Volume of the oscillator / MIDI out
- Octave/Fine/Course tuning controls per oscillator
- **ADSR** - Attack, Decay, Sustain, Release envelope of the sound.
- **Send to FX** controls the % of this pattern is sent to the FX panel
- **MIDI IN / OUT** channels (if you have LoopMidi installed)

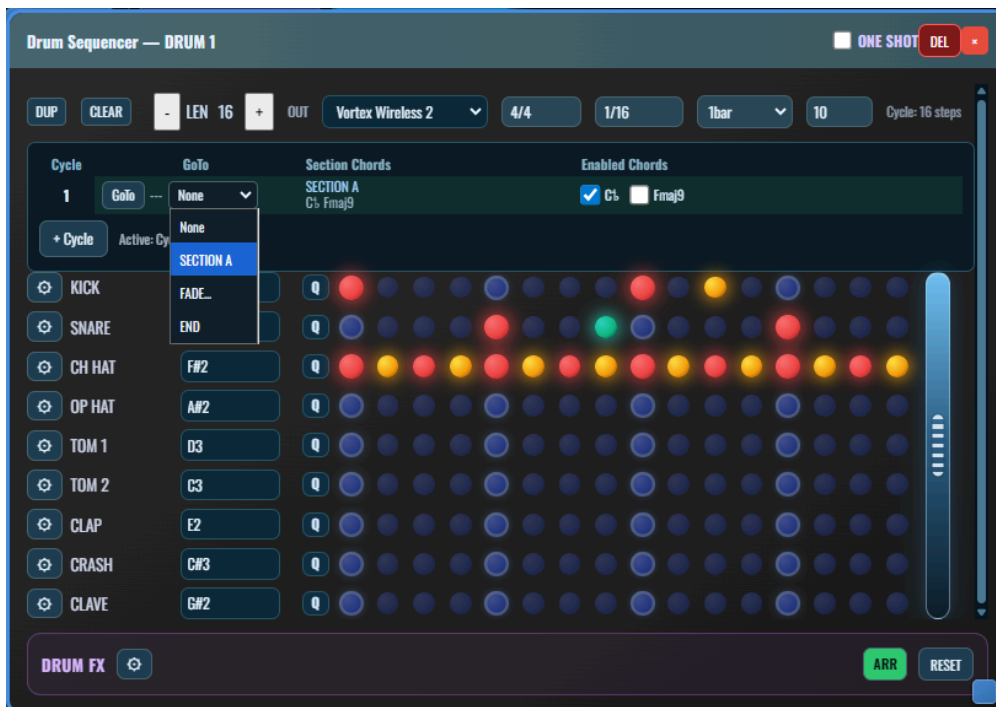


Click the  button to open up the arrangement for this pattern.



If **ARR** checkbox is checked in the transport panel, then **PATTERNS** and **DRUMS** and **LOOPS** will follow the arrangement (ie will they play during that chord)

So in this example the **PATTERN** that we created will be performed in both **C#** and **Fmaj9** chords. If we uncheck the **Fmaj9** chord it then this particular pattern will be muted when Fmaj9 is performed. This works with drums and loops too.



The Goto button allows you to create complex arrangements by jumping to different SECTIONS that you have written, repeat the same section, fade or end.

Transport Row



Play - Start audio playback at the current BPM

Pause - pauses the track

REC - creates a new audio loop (you have to enable your mic for this the first time each session)

FWD/BACK arrows - Forward and Back a chordbox

Lock - Locks position of all chordboxes for performance

BPM - Tempo + and - changes accordingly.

TS = Time Signature 4 / 4, 3 / 4, 7 / 8 etc

EAR button - listens and attempts to identify the chord you play to it from another source (ie piano / guitar)

Volume - master volume for Chromotone

LOOP - if **LOOP** is **ON** the chords will continuously cycle
when **LOOP** is **OFF**, chords change as you strum them.

ARR - when **ARR** is on **DRUMS**, **LOOPS** and **PATTERNS** follow the **ARR** schedule.

Loop Editor



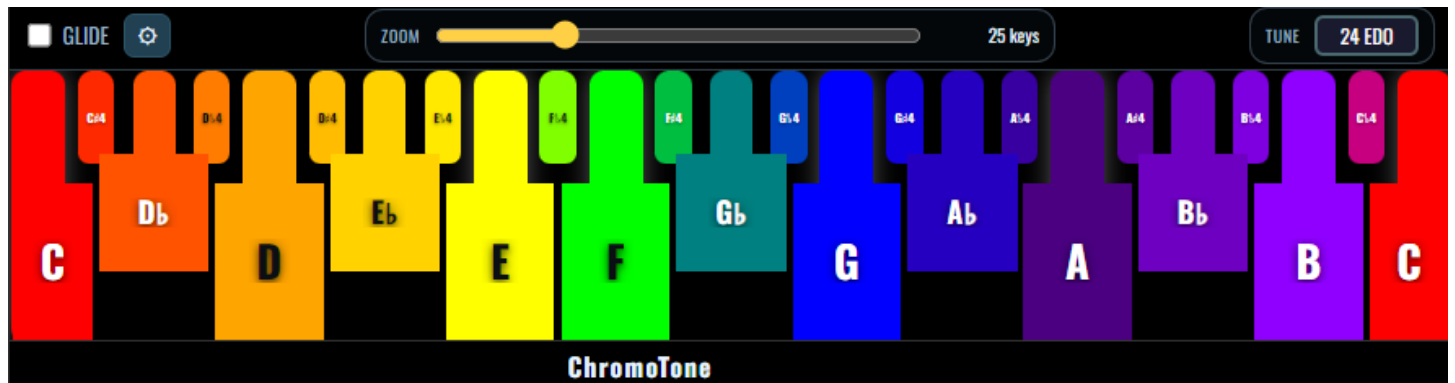
Click **FILE** - Load an audio file (short loops / samples at the correct tempo are going to work best)

Now you have an audio file loaded into the Loop Editor.

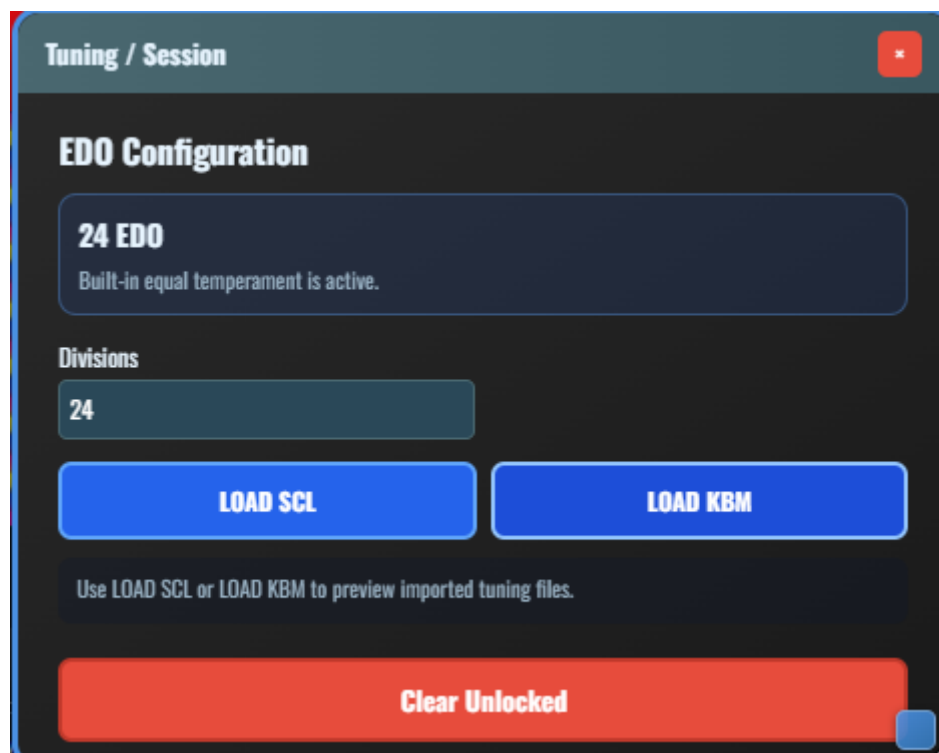


- **Transpose** - will force the audio to follow the changes for any transposed chordbox.
- **Retrigger** (Cycle or Bar or Off) what happens once the sample ends? Does it wait until the next bar, cycle or itself to play again.
- **ONE SHOT**. will be muted until clicked then returned to mute
- **DEL** - delete the pattern
- **File** - load up any audio file
- **EAR** - guess the notes in the sample
- **ZOOM** - visual zoom for the sample
- **ARR** - modify the program sequence for this sample
- **ADSR** - change the envelope of your sample default 15ms attack/release to get rid of pops on loops
- **COMP** - built in compressor threshold and ratio are in proportion
- **Delay** - innovative **fractional delay** $1/16$ = one sixteenth note but $1/11$ = one elftuplet (11 notes over 16). This is how to get non standard delays that do not overlap themselves.
- **OFFSET**- moves the calculated offset for the audio backwards or forwards
- **VERB** - a simple reverb
- **Tuning by STEP / OCTAVE / FINE** - CPU heavy
- **FIT SELECTION TO BAR / CYCLE** - attempts to beatmatch and time stretch your sample to fit a bar or cycle - use at your own risk
- **FFT / Grain** low FFT for drums, high for transposing sounds / pitched audio
- **Simple EQ** with lowpass and highpass. **Yellow handles are Q**, drag the frequency numbers to adjust
- Hold CTRL whilst dragging a slider to change that slider for ALL loops (very useful after recording a loop)

Keyboard



- Keyboard displays the notes in the current tuning
- The big notes are the regular 12-TET or closest approximation in your tuning - micro notes at the top and in between.
- Zoom shows more or less notes on screen
- Glide lets you play the screen like a stylophone
- TUNE button opens the TUNE window where you can load SCL / KBM or type in different EDO tunings directly



Default is 24 notes per octave but can go from 5-53 internally and any valid SCL or KBM file

Clear Unlocked resets wipes the current chord sequences before loading the tuning (keeps patterns / drums)

Save, load, and restore

- .xen session export is the full-project format for chords, instances, UI state, MIDI-related state, and more.

- If a project matters, export a real .xen file instead of relying only on browser-local save.

Shortcut Reference

The table below focuses on shortcuts already traced back to the current source or repo memory notes. Any shortcut not yet re-verified in the main file has been left out of this first implementation pass on purpose.

Keys	Where	What it does
Space	Main screen	Play or stop the transport.
Ctrl/Cmd + Z	Editing	Undo the last edit.
Ctrl + Y	Editing	Redo the last undone edit.
Ctrl/Cmd + Shift + Z	Editing	Redo the last undone edit.
Delete or Backspace	Chord editing	Delete the selected chord
Arrow Left or Right	Chord editing	Move the selected chord focus left or right.
Enter	Editing and dialogs	Confirm or commit the current action.
Escape	Editing and dialogs	Cancel or close the current modal or interaction.
+ or =	Main screen	Add a new chord box.
Arrow Up	Chordbox live control	Persistently raise the chordbox level by a small step.
Arrow Down	Chordbox live control	Momentarily lower or restore the chordbox level until key release.
Shift	Timing controls	Enable fine adjustment on supported timing drags and grid controls.
AS DFG HJ K	Anytime	C D E F G A B C (major)
WE TYU	During Playback	C# D# F# G# A#
[P O	During Playback	Down 1,2,3 micro steps

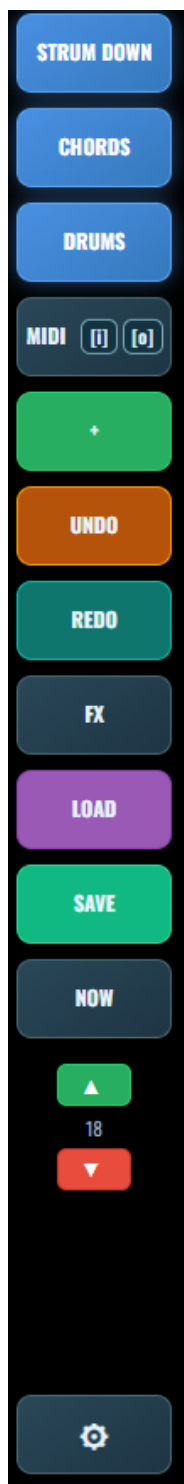
]] \	During Playback	Up 1,2,3 micro steps
Note below key is minor	During Playback	A+Z=Cm S+X=Dm
A+7	Anytime	C7
A+Z	Anytime	Cm
A+Z+[+7	Anytime	Cvm7
4	During Playback	Add a sus4
4 + 5	During Playback	Add b5
5 + 6	During Playback	Add #5
8 + 9	During Playback	b9
3 + 9	During Playback	#9
6 + 9	During Playback	6/9
7 + 8	During Playback	Maj7
0	During Playback	neutral or JI modifier
m	During Playback	Temporarily flip the quality from major to minor or vice versa

Recording a loop!

ChromoTone syncs MIDI and Audio by playing a loud ping / frequency sweep - make sure to output that ping to your monitors rather than the audience. And be careful with headphones



Menu



Strum Down = Low to High

VOICE LEADING chords / PAD on / off

DRUMS on or OFF

MIDI ON or OFF (IN/OUT)

ADD CHORD

UNDO / REDO

FX

**LOAD / SAVE a XEN file - LONG HOLD to save
SEQUENCE as PRESET in STARTUP**

**NOW - EXTERNAL CHORDBOX + CONTROLS
for 2nd DISPLAY**

GLOBAL TRANSPOSE + / -

GLOBAL SETTINGS